



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*svahaṃsam atarātmānaṃ cidrūpaṃ paramātmāni | [antarātmānaṃ ?]
yojayet parame haṃse nīrvāṇapadam aśnute || 45 ||
dvābhyāṃ ekaṃ vidhāyātha śubhadhyānena yogavit |
paramātmāsvarūpaṃ taṃ svam ātmā cainaṃ vicintayet || 43 ||
sulabdhānandasāmrājyaṃ kevalajñānabhāskaraḥ |
paramātmā svarūpohaṃ jātas tyaktabhavārṇavaḥ || 47 ||*

— Yogapradīpa, Chapter 1, Verses 45-47

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Yogapradīpa beckon you toward the ultimate union, the dissolving of the individual self into the vastness of the Divine. Imagine your own inner self, your antarātmā, as a swan, a haṃsa, soaring towards the supreme Self, the Paramātmā. This isn't merely a symbolic journey; it's an active process of merging your consciousness, your very being, with the all-pervading, blissful reality. The text urges you to unite the two, the individual and the universal, through auspicious meditation. This is the yogi's path, the skillful merging that leads to liberation.

Verse 46 elaborates on the method: through focused and benevolent contemplation, you, the yogi, can realize the true nature of the Paramātmā. Reflect on the Paramātmā's essence, and simultaneously, understand it to be your own self. This isn't about intellectual understanding, but about a deep, experiential knowing. It's about recognizing the inherent unity, the non-duality at the heart of existence.

The final verse culminates in a declaration of liberation. When you truly understand this union, you attain the "sulabdhānandasāmrājyaṃ," easily obtained empire of bliss. You become a radiant sun of pure knowledge, a "kevalajñānabhāskaraḥ." The profound realization dawns: "paramātmā svarūpohaṃ," the Supreme Self is my very own nature. Having realized this truth, you have crossed the ocean of worldly existence, "tyaktabhavārṇavaḥ," forever freed from its turbulent waves.

In our modern lives, filled with distractions and a relentless pursuit of external validation, these verses offer a powerful antidote. They remind you that true fulfillment lies not in accumulating possessions or achievements, but in recognizing the divinity within. By dedicating time to meditation and self-reflection, you can begin to quiet the noise of the ego and access the boundless peace and joy that reside within. The journey of the swan, the haṃsa, is your journey home to yourself, to the Divine.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify one small step you can take today to consciously merge your individual self with the awareness of the divine presence that surrounds and permeates you?